LEICHHARDT HOTEL KITCHEN

FOOD SAFETY GUIDE

2-hour / 4-hour rule

Keep potentially hazardous food safe when it is between 5°C and 60°C.

6 steps

Total time between **5°C and 60°C**

Under 2 hours

Use or refrigerate

2 to under 4 hours

Use straight away
Do not refrigerate

4 hours or more

Throw away

Add every period together. Putting food back in the fridge does not reset the time.

The rule is based on how quickly microorganisms grow in potentially hazardous food between 5°C and 60°C.

Adapted from Food Standards Australia New Zealand, Safe Food Australia InfoBite, 2-hour / 4-hour rule. See Safe Food Australia, Appendix 2, for using time as a control.

STEPS

1. Start timing when food leaves refrigeration at 5°C or below.
2. Record each time it comes out and goes back. Add up all time between 5°C and 60°C, including preparation, storage, transport and display.
3. Under 2 hours: use, sell or refrigerate at 5°C or below for later.
4. 2 to under 4 hours: use or sell straight away. Do not put it back in the fridge.
5. 4 hours or more: throw it away.
6. If in doubt, throw it out.